

How Personal Trainers Are Making An Extra \$300-\$500 A Day With AI

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 02, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wl6U50D3KN0> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter walks through his 5-part "Online Trainer Framework" — niche selection, AI-assisted content creation, lead magnet funnels, automated DM sales, and recurring coaching delivery — showing how trainers can build \$10K+/month businesses with minimal followers.

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Intro & Credibility 0:52

- Live stream recorded Sunday, August 2nd at 2:12 PM Eastern
- Goal stated upfront: show how to make an extra **\$300-\$500/day** as an online trainer
- Brandon's background:
 - ~30 years in the fitness industry
 - Online trainer since **2009-2010** — one of the first wave
 - Built a **multi-million dollar** online fitness business
 - Taught **over 15,000 people** how to grow online fitness businesses

- Audience drawn from across the US (Kentucky, Chicago, NYC, Miami, South Carolina, Oklahoma) and internationally (Vancouver, UK, Romania, Australia)

Student Testimonials Overview [1:30](#)

- Testimonials are used throughout the stream to show what's possible before teaching strategy
- Key student results highlighted:

Student	Starting Point	Result
Anna Quinn (Dallas, TX, 22 yrs)	~\$300 in online coaching	\$80,000 in 8 months
Kelly Nicole	\$1–2K/month, college senior	~\$20K/month at age 23
Kelly Ross	N/A	~\$260K for the year
Myron Gains (Fresh & Fit)	Government job	32 clients, \$7K in 30 days part-time; quit job, started Fresh & Fit
Karen Sutton (Miami, ex-Marine, Equinox trainer)	In-person trainer	\$27K/month
Maddie Cochland	Stay-at-home mom, never trained anyone	Started making money immediately
Lance	N/A	\$15K in 6 days (6 paid-in-fulls at \$997)
Zach Bowden	Active duty military, full-time	Putting up numbers while still serving
Charlie Diesel	~100 followers	Still getting clients
Corey Armstrong	Broke, working in Detroit gym barely covering rent	\$470,000 last year (~\$40K/month)
Will (DC, no experience)	Full-time job, wife, no training background	\$5,940 in first 7 days; \$32K+ first month
Deja Lewis	Living in Atlanta, tight budget	\$3,000 in a week; \$10K by the 14th of the month
Chris (cruise line actor)	Niche: helping cruise-ship travelers	\$19K+ that month
Darren	Tired gym trainer	\$15K in first month
Jen	N/A	\$49,927 in April; \$100K/month now
Adam/Alejandra	N/A	\$9K in first 28 days
Hunar	Romania	Getting clients internationally
Felicia Sarrod	Australia	Getting clients internationally

Why AI Won't Replace Trainers (But Will Replace Those Who Ignore It) 8:25

- Key quote: "Trainers who use AI will replace trainers who don't."
- Historical pattern of disruption — adapt or die:
 - **Kodak** — invented the digital camera in the 1970s but refused to commercialize it; went bankrupt
 - **Borders** — ignored Amazon (which started with books) and was put out of business
 - **Taxis** — could have built an app; Uber did it instead
- The pattern: old way → new technology arrives → adapters make money → non-adapters get left behind
- AI cannot replace the **accountability** function of a human trainer
 - Analogy: calendar reminders don't make you go to the gym, but a workout partner who's waiting for you does
 - Online trainers sell accountability, not information

What Online Training Actually Is 17:48

- **Not** Zoom workouts or FaceTime sessions
- The actual product:
 - Custom **training plan** for the client
 - Custom **nutrition plan**
 - Weekly (or periodic) **check-ins**
 - Daily **accountability** — ensuring they follow the plan
 - Weekly **adjustments** based on progress
 - Ongoing **support** — answering questions, troubleshooting, getting them back on track after setbacks
- Business model: trading **results** for income, not time for income
- What you're really selling:
 - **Accountability** — keeping clients consistent
 - **Feedback** — keeping them on track toward goals
 - **Support** — answering struggles and questions
 - **Direction** — acting as the GPS that recalculates when they make a wrong turn
- Why experience isn't required: anyone can give a workout and nutrition plan (ChatGPT can too); clients don't do it on their own — that's the gap you fill

Secret 1: Pick a Profitable Niche 21:13

- Generic = invisible; specific = money
 - Bad example: "I'm a fitness trainer"
 - Good example: "I help busy dads over 35 lose 25 pounds without leaving the gym"
- Specialist vs. generalist analogy: a heart surgeon earns far more than a general practitioner

- The 3-part niche framework — **Who + What + How**:
 - **Who** — gender AND age range (e.g., men 25–35)
 - Pick one gender; marketing to both is very difficult (Procter & Gamble runs Old Spice and Secret as completely separate brands for this reason)
 - Narrowing by gender cuts competition roughly in half
 - **What** — the specific problem you solve (e.g., getting ripped, fat loss, building muscle, energy/longevity)
 - **How** — your method (e.g., intermittent fasting + HIIT, keto, macro tracking)
- Brandon's original niche example:
 - Men → men aged 25–35 → who want to get ripped → using intermittent fasting + HIIT cardio
 - Result: dominated that micro-niche; clients couldn't price-shop because no one else was that specific
- Why content changes with the niche:
 - 25–35-year-old men want to get ripped mostly for dating/attraction → use models/women in content
 - 35–45-year-old men are often married with kids → content focuses on energy, longevity, being there for their kids
- "You can't boil an ocean. You can't boil a lake. You can't boil a pond. But you can boil a pot."
- **AI Prompt to find your niche** (screenshot recommended): > "Help me pick a profitable online fitness niche. Ask me 7 questions to identify who I can help, what problem I can solve, what method I use, and what results I can confidently deliver. Then give me five niche options."
 - Works in ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini

Secret 2: Build an Attention Machine (Content + Niche Hacking) 36:19

- You **don't need a large following** — the algorithm now rewards good content over follower count
 - Example shown: creator with 10K followers had a video with 5M views
- Steps to build content:
 - Find winning formats
 - Write hooks and script videos
 - Create captions
 - Repurpose content
 - Edit
 - Build lead magnets
- **Niche Hacking** — the core content strategy:
 - Step 1: Search your niche on TikTok or Instagram
 - Step 2: Find **outlier videos** — defined as videos that get 5–10x more views than the creator's follower count
 - Example: 1M views with 100K or fewer followers = 10x outlier
 - A video with 2.4M views from someone with 4M followers is NOT an outlier (Jeff Nippard example)

- Step 3: Use tools to analyze those videos:
 - **TikTok Sorter** (Chrome extension) — sorts videos by views, comments; gives engagement data
 - **Sort Feed** (Chrome extension) — downloads transcriptions of videos
- Step 4: Download the transcript of the outlier video
- Step 5: Paste transcript into ChatGPT or Gemini with this prompt (screenshot recommended):
 - Analyze the hook, pacing, topic score, structure, familiar framing, and CTA
 - Request a reusable template
- Step 6: Fill in the template with **your own content** — different examples, different ratings, your own method
 - Music analogy: same chord progression, different lyrics — many hit songs share progressions; you're finding the winning format and writing your own song
- Example niche hack demonstrated:
 - Searched "men's weight loss" → found outlier doing a 1-out-of-10 rating of fat loss methods
 - Used Sort Feed to grab transcript → pasted into ChatGPT → got hook analysis + template
 - Filled in own methods: intermittent fasting (7/10), tracking macros (10/10), peptides (8/10)
- **Gemini advantage:** can actually watch and analyze YouTube videos directly (Google product)
 - Gemini builds context from your Google/YouTube history
- Content rules reinforced during live audits:
 - Profile photo must show you looking like a trainer (no logos)
 - No **"millennial edits"** (fancy transitions, Windows Movie Maker-style intros)
 - Always explain WHY you're doing exercises — context is everything
 - Call out your specific avatar in content
 - Include captions — **70–80% of people watch Reels on mute**
 - Come in hot with a hook; never start with "All right, guys, so what we're gonna do today..."
 - Give specific advice (reps, sets, why it works) not just workout clips
 - Include a clear CTA in every video caption

Secret 3: Build Lead Magnets with AI 46:40

- **Lead magnet** = free tool or resource given away in content to capture leads
 - Examples: 3-day fat loss plan, grocery list, workout split guide, meal plan template, macro calculator, 7-day challenge, checklist, mistake guide
- The funnel flow:
 - Post content → tell viewers to comment a keyword → automation sends them a DM → they receive the free resource → you ask qualifying questions → book a sales call
- **How to build a lead magnet with AI** (Method 1 — AI Interview):
 - Go to Gemini (or ChatGPT)

- Say: **"I'm writing a guide called [title]. Interview me, ask me questions. Once you have all the answers, write the guide for me in my voice."**
- AI asks questions based on your real experience → guide is authentic, not generic slop
- **Method 2 — From existing YouTube video:**
 - Grab a YouTube video URL → paste into Gemini → prompt: **"Analyze this and write a guide I can give away as a lead magnet"**
 - Gemini watches the video and generates the guide
- **Turning the guide into a beautiful PDF with Gamma:**
 - Go to gamma.app → "Plain Text" → paste the AI-generated content
 - Select "Preserve Exact Text" → choose a template → Gamma auto-formats it into a professional-looking document with images
 - Export as PDF → hook it up to **Go High Level** → attach a trigger word to every video
 - Previously required writing + hiring a graphic designer; now done in minutes
- **Corey Armstrong's lead magnet example:**
 - Posted a video giving tips, offered "belly blaster free course" — told viewers to comment the word "course"
 - Thousands of people commented → all received automated DMs via Go High Level
 - Followed up in DMs → booked sales calls → closed clients → **\$400K–\$470K/year**
- Selling in public vs. private:
 - In public: always giving away free resources (never seems salesy)
 - In private (DMs): that's where the selling happens
 - "He's giving stuff away in public, but he's selling in private."

💬 **Secret 4: Turn Leads into Clients (DM Flow + Sales) 1:12:18**

- **5-step DM conversion process:**
 - Step 1: Start DM conversation by delivering the free guide
 - Step 2: Ask qualifying questions
 - "What's your goal right now?"
 - "What have you tried so far?"
 - "What's been stopping you from accomplishing that goal?"
 - Step 3: Offer to help build a plan
 - Step 4: Suggest times to jump on a Zoom call
 - Step 5: Run the sales call and close
- **Tool: Go High Level** (preferred over ManyChat)
 - More robust automation
 - Can collect phone numbers and emails

- Follow up via text AND email — not just Instagram DMs
- All top-earning students use Go High Level
- **Testimonial Harvest** (for trainers with no testimonials):
 - Step 1: Post that you're looking for 5 people to train **for free for 30 days**
 - Step 2: Also reach out to friends and family (they weren't going to pay anyway, so nothing lost)
 - Step 3: **Get the heaviest people you can find** — heavier people lose fat faster = more dramatic transformation
 - Step 4: Aim for 5–10 people; goal is to get **2–3 to the finish line** (some will drop off because they're not paying)
 - Step 5: Use before/after photos and testimonials in all future marketing
 - Step 6: Offer those free clients **half off** to continue — only time Brandon recommends discounting (luxury items don't go on sale, but these people helped you build your business)

Pricing Structure & Revenue Math 1:16:06

- These are the **floor** prices — students can charge more, never less:

Package	Price	Clients Needed for \$10K/month
16-week paid-in-full	\$997	41 clients (staggered)
Monthly recurring	\$297/month	34 clients
Weekly recurring	\$80/week	29 clients

- Reality: typically a combination of all three structures
- **Key math example:** 25 clients × \$80/week = **\$104,000/year** — six figures from just 25 clients
 - You don't need millions of followers to find 25 people
- **Why recurring coaching beats selling courses:**
 - Courses require selling to new people every single month
 - Coaching is recurring — clients stay month after month as long as they're getting results and accountability
- Common failure points (the bottleneck):
 - No clear niche
 - No consistent content protocol
 - No way to generate leads
 - No sales system
 - No lead follow-up system
 - Need the **entire system** working together

High Ticket Trainer (HTT) Program Breakdown 1:18:56

- Not just a course — described as a **mentorship program**
- **5 live trainings per week** (one with Brandon personally reviewing Instagrams and sales calls)
- Phase 1 — Foundation:
 - Mindset
 - Niche selection (deep dive beyond the prompt)
 - AI positioning
 - Instagram profile optimization
 - Eliminating impostor syndrome
- Phase 2 — Content:
 - Mastering the algorithm for short-form
 - Viral content styles
 - Hook writing
 - How to shoot content + equipment needed
 - AI content tools (many beyond what's shown in the stream)
- Phase 3 — Leads:
 - Multiple lead funnel strategies (lead magnets are just one of many)
 - Different approaches to lead generation
- Phase 4 — Sales:
 - DM sales scripts
 - 10-minute sales call script
 - 60-minute sales call script
 - Objection handling coaching
 - Weekly sales drills and role-play with Brandon's sales manager (Brian, his best friend and head of sales team)
 - Lead follow-up system ("the real money is in the follow-up")
- Phase 5 — Delivery:
 - How to actually coach clients (no experience needed)
 - Coaching program setup, payments, agreements, consultation forms
 - Workout programs and meal plans
 - AI tools to streamline delivery
- **Bonuses:**
 - Social media growth hack modules
 - 30-day challenge funnel
 - Facebook Groups monetization
 - Facebook Ads course (fitness-niche specific)
 - TikTok Ads course

- Personal one-on-one coach for 90 days
- Lifetime access to all updates
- **Who it's for:** people willing to post consistently, learn sales, build a real business, use AI — NOT for get-rich-quick seekers or people who refuse to post

Live Instagram Audits 1:28:57

- Brandon audited ~10 trainers' Instagram pages live; recurring feedback themes:

Common mistakes seen across accounts: - **Logo as profile photo** — nobody cares about your logo; use a photo of yourself looking ripped/in shape - **Millennial edits** — fancy transitions, Windows Movie Maker-style intros; kills credibility - **No niche in the content** — putting a niche in your bio but posting generic workouts doesn't count - Example: "I help busy professionals" but every post is just you doing rows in a gym with zero context - Jen (making \$100K/month) has kids in her videos, works out at home, calls out "busy moms" — her content *is* her niche - **No CTA** — never telling people to comment a word, download something, or book a call - **Showing workouts without explaining why** — need reps, sets, reasons, benefits - **Starting videos slowly** — must hook immediately; cut all intros - **No captions** — 70–80% watch on mute - **Using someone else's workout clips** — if marketing to women, you still need to be explaining and coaching, not just showing women exercising - **Mismatched niche** — a 19-year-old claiming to help "busy dads over 35" does not work

Specific audit highlights: - **Daniel White:** strong niche ("helping dads become lean, strong, and confident"), but content is generic exercises with no dad-specific context — needs to post dad content the way Jen posts mom content - **Physique Quest:** good photo (holding a weight), decent bio, but bio is crammed and workouts have no context; mic volume too low in gym videos - **Zach Aesthetics:** great shredded profile pic, strong hook style, good testimonials — closest to ready; needs captions and more format variety - **Fitness with Diaz:** at least giving some advice verbally, on the right path, but generic niche and videos start too slowly - **Fit Black Guru:** 19 years old marketing to 35+ dads — impossible to credibly pull off; advised to restart with an age-appropriate niche - **Mo (Saudi Arabia):** no bio, looks like a dancer not a trainer, distracting logo watermark in center of screen, no context - **Coach Jeremy (NJ):** helping women 40+ but content shows random workouts with no connection to that avatar - **Nathan G2:** too wide an age range (25–50); Christian men niche in bio but zero Christian content; shown Zach Bowden as example of how to do it right — reading Bible passages and connecting to fitness discipline - **Zach Bowden example:** markets to Christian men by reading Bible passages on the treadmill, relating scripture to fitness discipline, posting "4 habits every Christian needs" — doesn't even need it in his bio because the content IS the niche

The Exponential Curve & Coaching Argument 2:52:38

- Most people expect **linear** results (more effort = proportional output)
- Reality is an **exponential curve**: slow build, then a sharp hockey-stick upswing
- The "quitting zone": most people quit right before the curve kicks in because results come slower than expected
- **Coaching shortens the curve:**
 - With coaching: reach the inflection point faster → make money sooner

- Without coaching: may spend years in the boom-bust cycle of starting and stopping
- Algebra analogy — you didn't learn algebra by yourself; a teacher made it possible
- Opportunity cost: every month you delay is money you're leaving on the table

"Experience is the best teacher, but it doesn't have to be *your* experience."

- LeBron analogy: even the best player doesn't win without the right team; Carmelo Anthony was elite and never won because he was never on the right team

? Q&A / Super Chats 2:55:58

- Super chat from Matt: supporting Brandon since 2011
- Super chat from Tyler (UK, age 17): asking whether to pursue university alongside personal training certification
 - Brandon's answer: it depends on your goals; you can absolutely do both — Kelly Nicole was making \$20K/month her senior year of college while enrolled in HTT
- Brandon closed the stream by inviting anyone interested to book a **free, no-obligation call** with his team via the link in the description/comments